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A GovReport Dataset Collection and Processing

For GAO reports, their summaries are organized as highlights. We collect GAO reports that include corresponding highlights and were published before Jul 7, 2020 . The reports and highlights are published in PDF files. Most of the highlights are also reorganized and shown on the web page as HTML. Since PDF parsing is more prone to errors than web parsing, we only keep the reports whose highlights can be obtained on the corresponding web page to ensure the quality of extracted gold-standard summaries. For reports, we first convert the PDF files to HTML using PDFMiner[6]. We then parse the HTML into text into sections and paragraphs with handcrafted parsing rules. We remove the reports that do not have cover pages, as our rules are constructed for documents with then. We further remove parsed documents with empty sections, non-capitalized section titles, or a single section, since these are common patterns of incorrectly parsed documents. Failed parsing would also result in short documents. Therefore, we examine the reports with shorter length and then filter out 10% of the shortest reports.

[6] https://github.com/euske/pdfminer